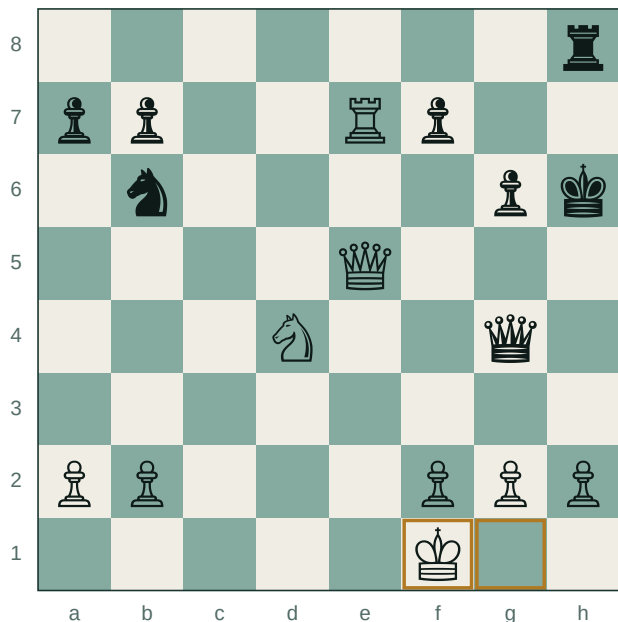


# Deflection tactics: Black, move 29

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 29.Kxf1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**29...Qd1+ 30. Qe1 Qxd4 31. Qe3+ Qxe3**

**29...Qd1+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From d1 it attacks king on f1 and knight on d4. Recorded reply: **30.Qe1**.

**30...Qxd4** The queen captures the knight on d4. Recorded reply: **31.Qe3+**.

**31...Qxe3** The queen captures the queen on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +12. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +12:** the balance goes from -1 to +11. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.